anymore. The religious leaders agreed to try to live peacefully with each other.



On March 12, 1930, Gandhi left his ashram in Ahmedabad with a group of seventy-eight people. They headed south for a march to the sea that would take almost a month. The weather was unbearably hot, so they traveled during the cooler parts of the day: early morning and evening. Villagers sprinkled the dusty dirt roads with water to keep the dust down. They threw leaves and flower petals on the path to make walking easier.

Along the 240-mile journey, Gandhi picked up hundreds of followers. The group grew to several thousand, a mix of young and old, men and women, Muslim, Christian, Hindu, and untouchable. A few local newspapermen followed along at first. As the news spread and the crowds grew, newspapers all around the world featured articles about the march on their front pages.